

**SUNNYSIDE COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION
2005 ANNUAL MEETING
Tuesday, May 3, 2005
7:00 PM**

BOARD MEMBERS PRESENT (5)

RJ & VALERI CARDELLO
KEN RIEGER
MIKE SARULLO
DAVE WIELANDT
AL WILLARD

MEMBERS PRESENT (22)

BOND, DEGIROLAMO, ETTINGTON, GILL, GISBRECHT, JOHNSON, KALLISH, KIRK, LAFOREST, LAFRANCHI, LAMAN, MEGEFF, MENDENHALL, MORREALE, PAGES, PETERSON, (RIEGER), ROWE, SMITH, SPELLACY, TROST, (WIELANDT) and WILL.

PROXIES RECEIVED (5)

BRUMFIELD, GRANER, KIM, KOTOWSKI, PARKER, and URIU.

INTERESTED (NON-VOTING) RESIDENTS

RIGG

QUORUM REQUIREMENTS WERE MET (26 or more member families) AND THE MEETING BEGAN AT 7:00 P.M.

1.0 CRIME PREVENTION – GUEST SPEAKER

John Despot with the LA County Sheriff's Office kindly attended the meeting to inform us about crime trends and prevention strategies with Sunnyside residents. Here is a summary of his talk:

- a) **Identity Theft** - is the #1 crime on the Peninsula (although not a violent crime and the losses can usually be insured). The top cause of identity theft is mail theft, which occurs at all hours of the day in all of the Peninsula's communities. To prevent mail and identify theft, John suggested putting a lock on your mailbox and refrain from putting outgoing mail in it and not raising the mailbox 'flag.' Since criminals steal outgoing and incoming checks and 'wash' them, monitor your cashed checks and bank statements closely and drop your outgoing payments and mail in authorized US Mailboxes only.
- b) **Residential Burglaries** – many occur during daytime 'banker's hours' when residents are at work or out shopping. John discussed several cases in which contractors, who had done previous home improvement work inside a residence, returned a year or two later on to steal jewelry, valuables and even saw open a safe! Always supervise your contractors and research them to make sure your home is safe during and after home improvement work. Watch out for your home and those of your neighbors during the day whenever possible, and don't hesitate to call the Sheriff if you see anything suspicious.
- c) **Soliciting** – The City of Rancho Palos Verdes requires that all solicitors obtain City permits. John cited several known cases of fraudulent door-to-door soliciting including a man posing as a neighbor who was raising funds for a sports team. Never give out money to anyone who you don't personally know who comes to your door. Ask to see their permit and ask for their contact details, then call the Lomita Sheriff's Station and give them a full description so they can be investigated. Remember, if their cause is valid, they will have no problem providing you with the information and returning later for your support or business.

- d) **Unlocked Car Theft** – Although the homes on Sunnyside and Sol Vista are fairly secluded and tucked away, John warned that we may have a false sense of security about the safety of our cars. Another recent crime trend is the theft of articles inside unlocked cars, and even the theft of items *left in view* inside locked vehicles. Always lock your car doors each time you park in the driveway, roll up the windows and conceal your valuables.
- e) **Miscellaneous Tips** – John suggested that there are a few things residents can do to improve their chances of avoiding the above-mentioned crimes. These include having a well-lit house, using a security system, owning dogs, and maintaining landscaping to make it hard to allow a criminal to ‘lie in wait.’ Always be on the lookout in your neighborhood and feel free to call the Lomita Sheriff’s Station at 310-539-1661 whenever you have a question or see something suspicious.

2.0 NEIGHBORHOOD WATCH

Sydney Bond wanted to remind Association members that she is the Area Coordinator for the Palos Verdes Neighborhood Watch organization. She wanted to thank Lorraine Kirk and Joanne Peterson for their service as block captains and distributing the Neighborhood Watch notices that we all receive in the mail. At the meeting, Jack Trost and Sue Spellacy volunteered to take on the 2 vacant block captain positions. If you would like to make a donation or get involved with Neighborhood Watch, please contact Sydney or Dave Bond at 310-832-3429.

3.0 FRONT ENTRANCE UPGRADE PROJECT

In 2005, the Sunnyside Community Association received an RPV/Waste Management Grant and conducted a special assessment in order to upgrade the front entrance sign and area. Because of the time that the outgoing Board and President Dave Wielandt lent to the project this spring, Sunnyside Ridge has the best-looking entrance area in RPV! Contractors removed the old metal gating material from both sets of signs, leveled out the stone columns and then filled the area back in with matching Palos Verdes Stone material. The area was then re-landscaped.

The Association owes many thanks to Ron & Karen LaForest, who graciously donated the ‘Sunnyside Ridge’ lettered signs. The LaForests made the signs at their own business and provided the materials, time and labor at no charge. The Board had a vote to chose the final font design for the letters prior to the installation, and the black background was added and refined to make the signs easier to read in direct sunlight. The Board will continue to work to enhance the lighting and the lettering to ensure visibility at night.

Future enhancements to the entrance area were discussed including fencing to prevent daytime & nighttime parking by non-residents, as well as seasonal landscaping. Residents may also want to consider using some of the remaining beautification funds on matching address plaques or posts.

4.0 FINANCIAL REVIEW

Al Willard provided a financial report of the actual expenses incurred in the 2004-2005 fiscal year (attached). His report also contained a proposed budget for the 2005-2006 fiscal year, including known expenses and potential projects. It appears that there will be approximately \$3,500 in the treasury available for further improvements to the entrance area.

5.0 ANNUAL DUES

The 2005-2006 Annual Dues rate remains \$60 per year for each member household. Social Members may also keep their memberships for this rate. Dues are to be paid immediately for those residents who did not bring their dues payment to the Annual Meeting.

6.0 RESIDENT ISSUES

- a) **Website:** Mike Sarullo is continuing to administer the Sunnyside Community Association website at www.ssrrhoa.com. All residents are encouraged to check the website periodically for notice of upcoming Board meetings and Association events, as well as retrieve archived documents such as meeting minutes and governance documents. Many thanks to Webmaster Mike for his continued work on this project.
- b) **Member Directory:** At the meeting, new residents were welcomed to the neighborhood, including the Rigg family (2320), the Murphys (2417), the Kim family (2203), and the xxxxx (2202). A new edition of the Association phone directory will be published this summer and distributed via hard copy to all Sunnyside Ridge and Sol Vista residents. While the directory is a helpful tool for crime prevention and getting to know neighbors, the Board has decided not to publish it on the SSRR website to respect family privacy.
- c) **Off-Street Parking:** Neighborhood residents are reminded to please park off the street on their private driveways. Street parking can pose hazards due to hills and blind spots. This also applies to both the visitors and workers at Aunt Mona's Care Home/McAllister at 2522 Sunnyside Ridge. Also, please keep trash cans off the street and located on your driveway. Most residents agree that Sunnyside is nicer looking and much easier to navigate than other nearby streets because of our off-street parking.
- d) **Neighborhood Safety:** All residents are requested to comply with the speed limit of 20-25 MPH when driving on Sunnyside Ridge and to watch out for kids on skateboards or motorized scooters. Some of the steep areas on our street make it difficult to see pedestrians and children at play until the last moment, so please drive slowly and defensively.
- e) **Septic Tanks:** All of the homes in our neighborhood are on individual septic systems which may need to be maintained every few years. A septic tank maintenance guide was scanned in and placed on the Association website for reference at www.ssrrhoa.com. Nick Dragich with Peninsula Pump and Septic (310-832-4800) has done a lot of work in our neighborhood and is very familiar with our existing systems, should you have any septic questions or needs.
- f) **Tree Trimming:** A request was made to remind the members to keep their trees trimmed for the benefit of everyone's views. The City of Rancho Palos Verdes has a 16' height requirement on all trees in our area.
- g) **Hazardous Waste:** LA County maintains a standing hazardous waste dropoff site that is open every Friday, Saturday and Sunday from 9 am - 3 pm. They accept items such as used computer equipment, paint and yard chemicals on a 'drive-thru' basis at 1400 N Gaffey (in front of the San Pedro community gardens below the 'smokestack'). For more information on the type of hazardous wastes accepted, call them at 1-800-988-6942.
- h) **Voting:** Peggy Pages encouraged the neighborhood to exercise their voting power in local elections. She had recently voted on a school board ballot and was the only other person besides the 2 polling workers to vote that day. To learn more about local voting opportunities, check the newspaper and watch your mail for sample ballots.
- i) **Recycling:** Valeri Cardello made a request to ask that our neighborhood increase the commitment to recycling. The \$4,500 grant that the Association was awarded last year to upgrade the entrance area directly came from dollars that Waste Management received when they turned in our street's cans, paper, plastics and glass. Valeri asked that everyone please store cardboard boxes, laundry detergent bottles, beverage cans, food jars, newspapers, etc. in their blue waste cans each week and put them out only on Monday mornings. Also, our street's designated green yard waste day is Thursday. Any lawn and plant clippings that are thrown out on Mondays are not recycled into compost, but they instead increase landfill mass. Please save green waste in the green waste cans and put it out on Thursdays only. If you need more blue or green waste cans, Waste Management will deliver them to you free in about a week if you call them at 310-830-7100.
- j) **Narbonne Avenue Easement Property:** As reported in 2002, there is still no definitive ownership of this property on LA County records. It is still a non-taxed area noted only as Narbonne Avenue Easement. There is no Map Book and parcel number noted. Likewise, the City of RPV has not

vacated their easement on this land. Marty Ettington offered to try and research the property in case the area can be put to use by our neighborhood.

7.0 ELECTION OF OFFICERS

Marty Ettington and Johnny DeGirolamo were nominated to serve a two-year term on the Board of Directors. Though their two-year terms are ended, Ken Rieger, Valeri Cardello and RJ Cardello were also nominated to continue their service on the Board. Mike Sarullo will remain on the Board into the second year of his term.

MOTION #1: Jack Trost moved and Barbara Johnson seconded that the Members accept these nominations. Motion passed unanimously.

MOTION #2: Ron LaForest moved and Frank Gill seconded that all the Board nominees be approved. Motion passed unanimously.

8.0 NEXT MEETING and ADJOURNMENT

The Board of Directors decided to meet on Thursday, May 5 in order to elect officers. The meeting was set for 7 p.m. at the Rieger residence.

The meeting adjourned at 9:00 p.m.

**SUNNYSIDE COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION
FINANCIAL REPORT
MAY 2005**

2004-2005 ACTUALS

Income from Dues:	\$3,120.00
Special Assessment:	\$6,400.00
City of RPV Grant (2/3 payment):	\$2,970.00
Beginning Balance - 4/1/04:	\$475.16
TOTAL INCOME	\$12,965.16

ENTRANCE MAINTENANCE

Water:	\$399.01
Electric:	\$461.52
Monthly Gardening:	\$780.00
Annual Tree Trimming:	-
Supplies, Miscellaneous:	\$242.54
Sub-Total	\$1,883.07

SOCIAL ACTIVITIES

Summer Social:	\$320.14
Holiday Party:	\$811.34
Bereavement, Other:	-
Sub-Total	\$1,131.48

ADMINISTRATIVE

Copying/Paper/Mailing/Website:	\$128.73
Sub-Total	\$128.73

EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS

Database, Miscellaneous:	\$-
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ENTRANCE UPGRADE

Labor masonry	\$2,478.00
Sign, lighting, etc.	\$394.77
Landscaping, flowers etc.	\$800.00
Permits	\$147.00
Building Materials	\$1,437.96
Sub-Total	\$5,257.73

TOTAL EXPENDITURES \$8,401.01

2005-2006 PROPOSED BUDGET

Income from Dues:	\$3,180.00
(50 current Regular & 3 Social Members)	
City of RPV Grant (1/3 payment):	\$1,530.00
Beginning Balance - 5/1/05:	\$4,564.15
TOTAL ESTIMATED INCOME	\$9,274.15

ENTRANCE MAINTENANCE

Water:	\$450.00
Electric:	\$500.00
Monthly Gardening:	\$800.00
Annual Tree Trimming:	-
Supplies, Miscellaneous:	\$250.00
Landscaping:	\$700.00
Upgrade (removal of bus shelter):	\$1,000.00
Sub-Total	\$3,700.00

SOCIAL ACTIVITIES

Summer Social:	\$320.00
Holiday Party:	\$800.00
Bereavement, Other:	-
Sub-Total	\$1,120.00

ADMINISTRATIVE

Copying/Paper/Mailing:	\$25.00
Website Registration/Hosting:	\$30.00
Sub-Total	\$55.00

EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS

Communications system/Ham Radio	\$800.00
Database, Miscellaneous:	\$100.00
Sub-Total	\$900.00

ESTIMATED EXPENDITURES \$5,775.00

Balance May 1, 2005 \$4,564.15

Estimated Balance - May 1, 2006 \$3,499.15